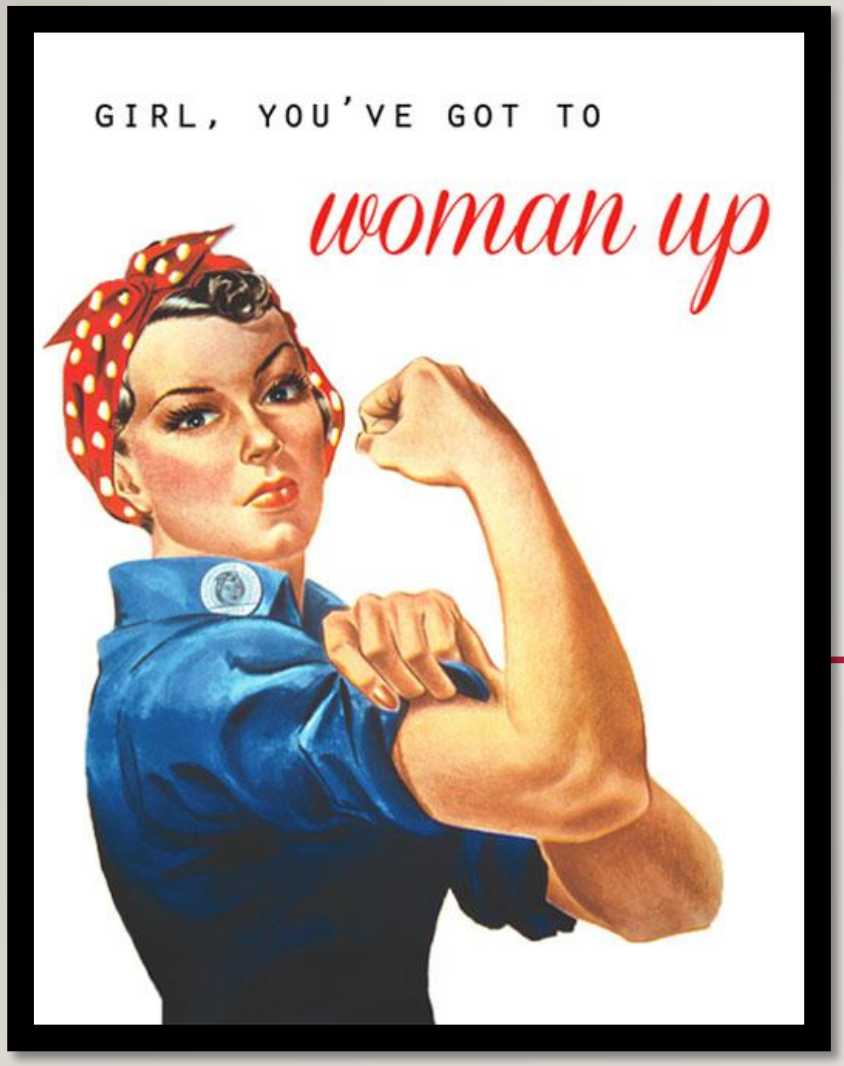






# MANNING UP & FEMALE LEADERS

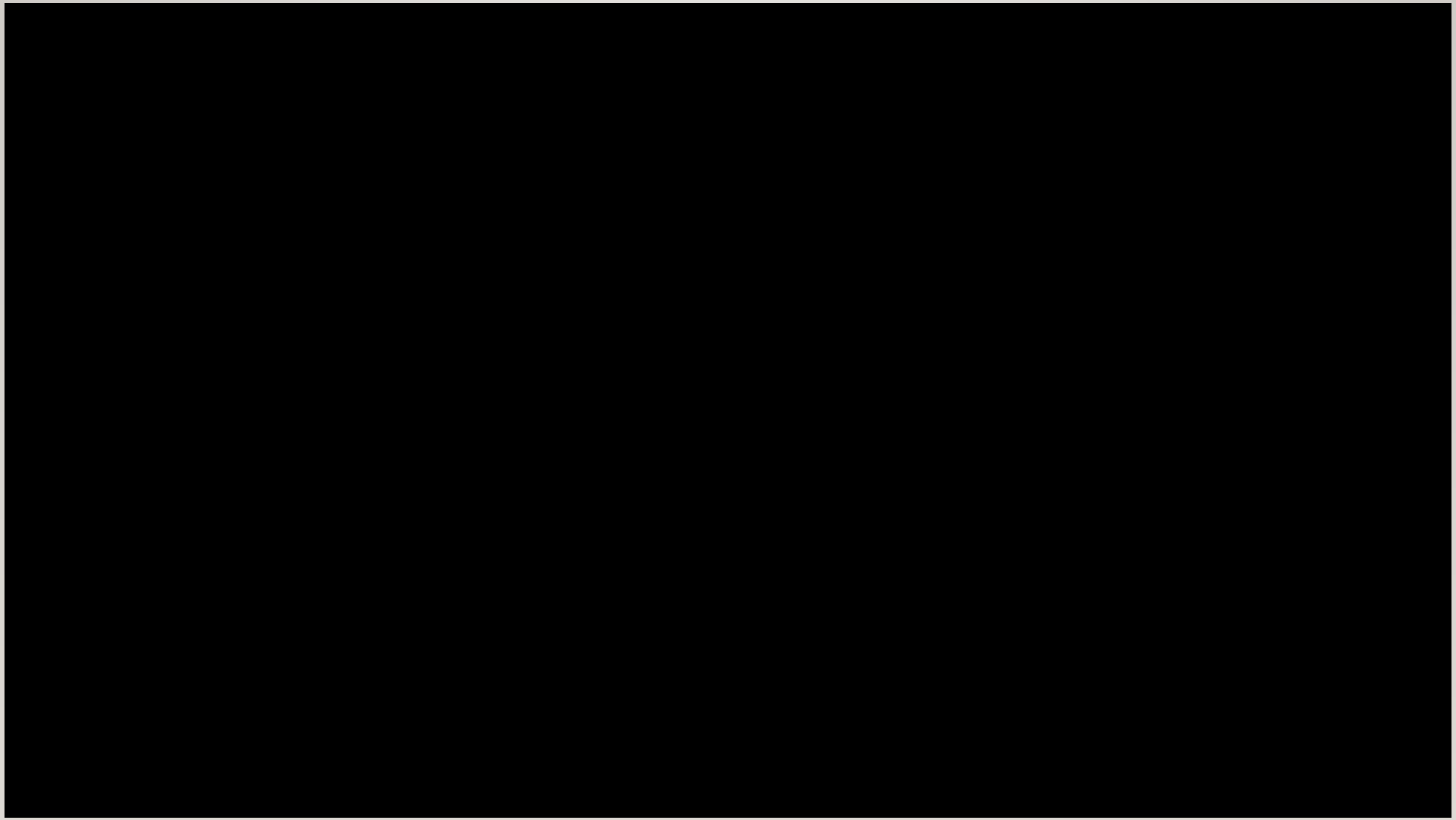
**THE SELF & SOCIAL IDENTITIES**

# READING CHILDREN'S BOOKS THROUGH A PSYCHOLOGICAL LENS



- Read your assigned book with a **psychological lens**
- Discuss these 3 questions:
  - **What does this story teach children about how gender/social categories work?**
  - **Where do you see categorization, stereotypes, identity denial, or belonging?**
  - **What might a 5-year-old take away from this story that differs from you?**
- *Be ready to share:*
  - **One psychological concept** illustrated by the story about gender
  - **One thing you would question or critique**
  - **As we listen to each group, consider:** *What are children actually learning—not just from what the book says, but from how characters respond to gender, the images, etc.?*

# THE MASK YOU LIVE IN

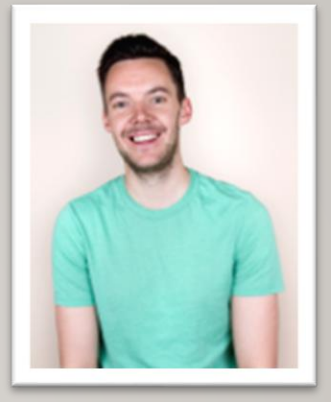


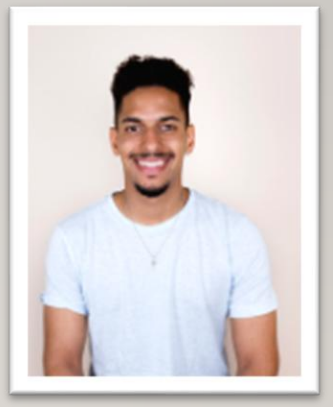
# EDWARDS: BEING A MAN IN COLLEGE

- Increasing trends of males struggling in college academically and emotionally—this directly impacts their mental health

- Student affairs, faculty, and staff have not been trained on how to view the male college experience through a "gendered lens" and most psychology research has also ignored this

  - "Leads to either reliance on stereotypical gender scripts or failure to consider men as gendered beings. . . ." Davis & Laker

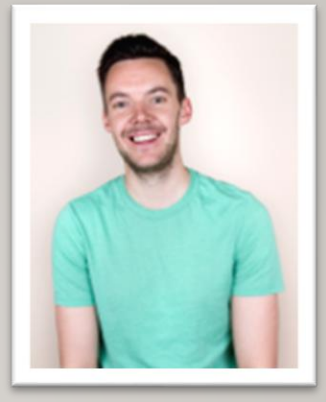


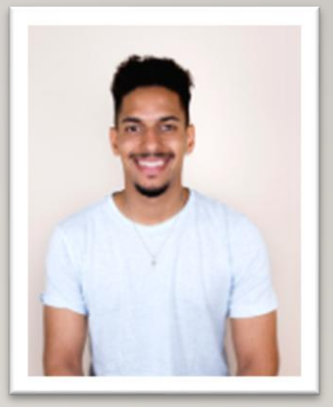




# EDWARDS: BEING A MAN IN COLLEGE

- Gender, like race, class, and sexual orientation, is socially constructed (Weber, 2001)
- The traditional definition of masculinity refers to the dominant culture's normative definition of masculinity and is reinforced by misogyny and homophobia
- Kindlon & Thomson (2000) argued men learn "emotional illiteracy" which relates to increases in alcohol and drug use, suspension, unprotected sex, etc.

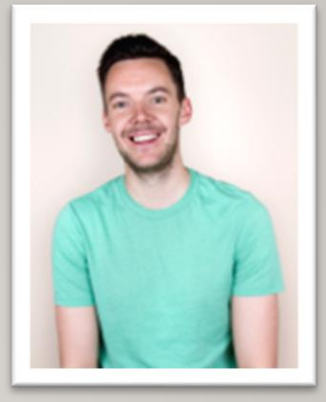


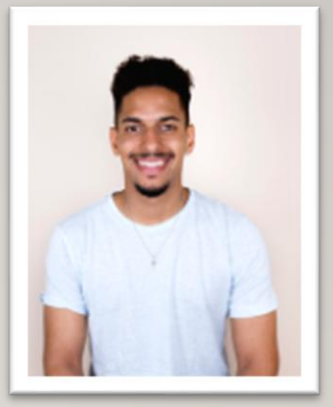




# EDWARDS: BEING A MAN IN COLLEGE

- <u>Research Questions:</u>
  - How do college men come to understand themselves as men?
  - How does this understanding of what it means to be a man change over time, if at all?
  - What are the critical influences on this process?
- <u>Method:</u>
  - 10 College Men, Three Interview Sessions
    - 1) Broad open-ended questions
    - 2) Re-examine past responses and examine new themes
    - 3) Discussed emerging themes







# MALE COLLEGE IDENTITY STUDY: RESULTS

- Initial Themes: "being in control," "trying not to cry," "not preparing," and "proving masculinity as insecurity"

- Initial Categories: "falling into society's expectations," "proving manhood," "crying," "traditional definition of masculinity," and "being socialized"

- Participants experienced society's expectations of men to be a set of very narrow, rigid, rules defining who they can't be (i.e., gay, feminine, emotional)

- No participants could remember when they weren't conscious of these rules

Chart on p. 215

**Social Context: External Expectations of What It Means To Be a Man**

- Dominant society's expectations
- Subordinated cultural group expectations

**Performing Masculinity According to External Expectations**

**Phase 1: Feeling a Need to Put On a Mask:**

- To meet society's expectations after feeling like one does not measure-up as self
- To portray an image of a man according to society's expectations
- To cover-up aspects of self that do not fit society's expectations
- Both intentionally/consciously and unintentionally/unconsciously

**Phase 2: Wearing a Mask:**

- By "partying" as college men
- To make transgressing against society's expectations in other ways acceptable
- In response to experiencing oppression
- By creating one's own mask based on society's expectations

**Phase 3: Experiencing and Recognizing Consequences of Wearing a Mask**

- Demeaning and degrading relationships and attitudes towards women
- Limited relationships with other men, including friends and fathers
- Loss of authenticity and humanity

**Beginning to Transcend External Expectations**

- Accepting the ways the mask doesn't fit
- Critical influences and critical incidents helped men transcend the performance in certain aspects of their lives and/or in specific circumstances

# DISCUSSION OF MALE IDENTITY

- Do you agree men have to constantly "perform masculinity' and what are the consequences from "wearing a mask"?

- What is Duke's masculinity culture? Does it fit or not with this article?

# LATU: WHO IS A LEADER?



- What types of qualities make someone a leader?
- Leader stereotypes are predominantly masculine (Koenig, Eagly, Mitchell, & Ristikari, 2011) which protect men (Walton & Cohen, 2003), but socially threaten women (Steele, 1997)
- Worldwide only 19.6% of parliament is female (Quotaproject, 2012)
- The awareness that women are less likely to succeed in leadership can undermine women's performance on all leadership-related tasks—motivating employees, managerial decisions, and negotiating



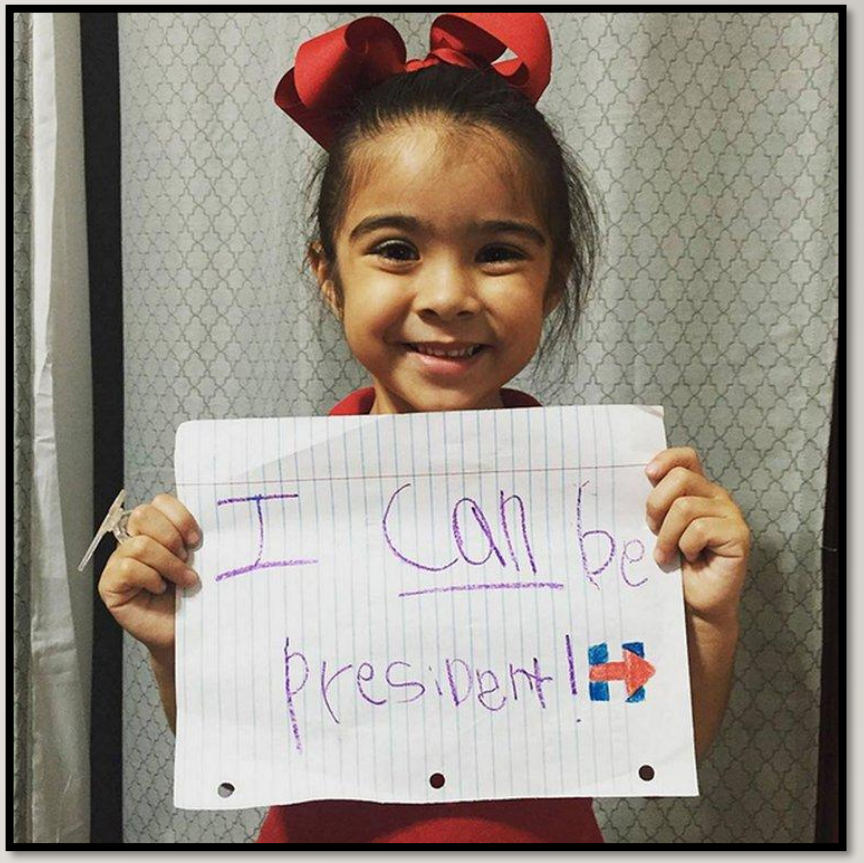

Cecilia Mo's Study on Gender Bias in Leadership Selection (2015) Political Behavior

# LATU: SUCCESSFUL FEMALE LEADERS STUDY

- Past work shows exposure to female leaders can threaten women (inferiority, lower aspirations)

- <u>Research Question:</u>
  - But can positive female role exposure impact women's behavior?

- <u>Method:</u>
  - Priming with female leaders (Hillary Clinton/ Angela Merkel vs. no image or Bill Clinton)
  - Impacts on giving a persuasive speech

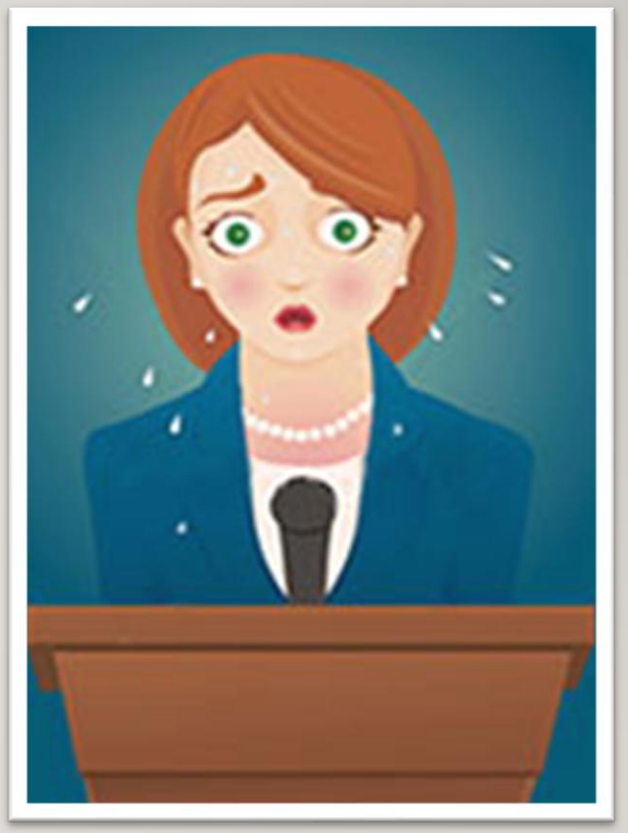




# SUCCESSFUL FEMALE LEADERS STUDY

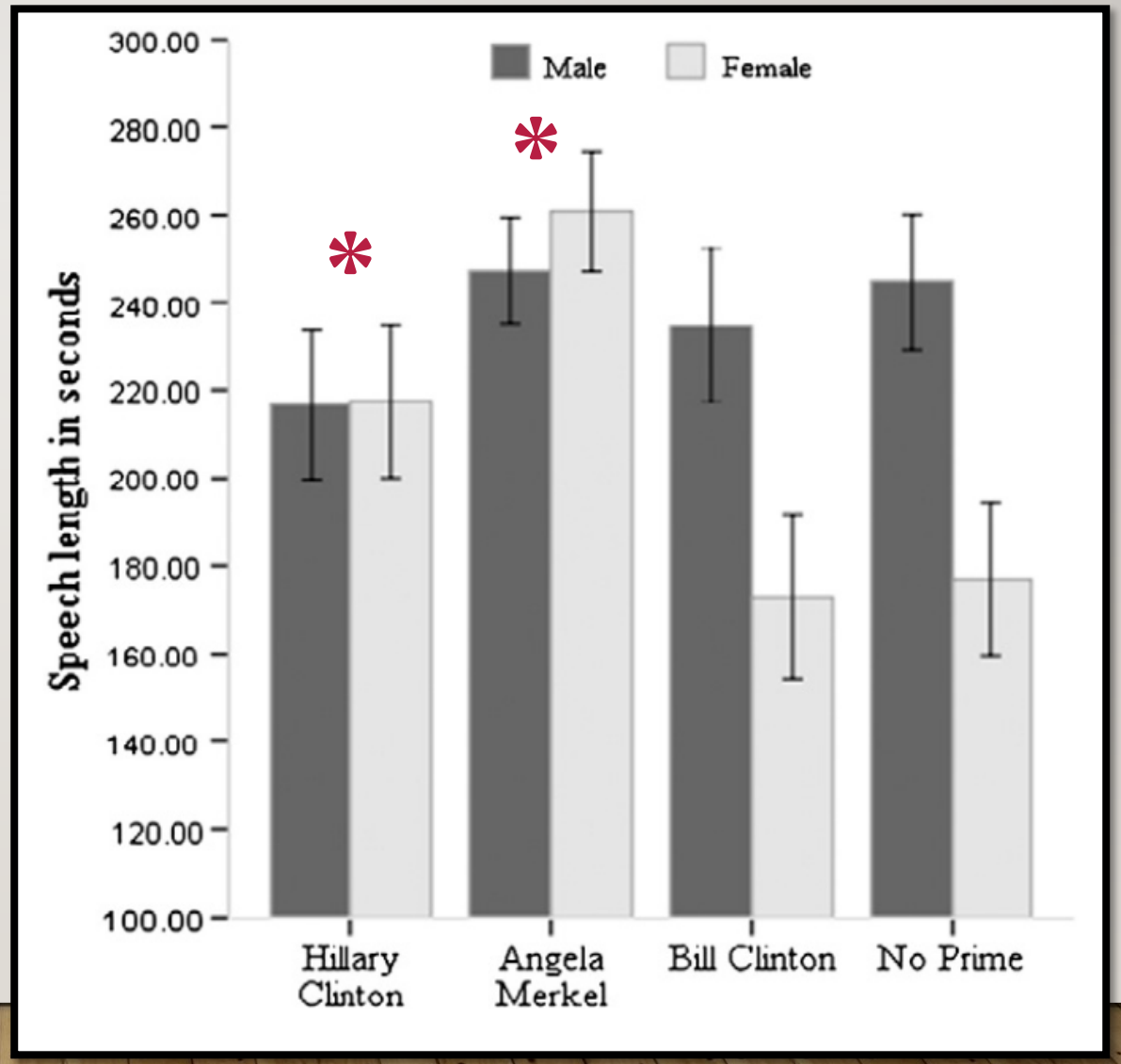
- <u>Predictions:</u>
- In the absence of a female role model, men would speak longer than women, but this difference should disappear when female participants are exposed to a female role model

- Speaking time was chosen because it is an expression of a person's dominance and power, and speeches were coded and participants rated their own performance



# SUCCESSFUL FEMALE LEADERS STUDY: RESULTS

- Subtle reminders of other successful women improved women's behavior and closed the gender gap
  - Displayed more empowered objective behavior (speaking time)
  - Perceived as more empowered (perceived speech quality)
  - Perceived their own performance more positively



# DISCUSSION

- Whether they were exposed to male or female role models, men performed equally well—why do you think this is?
- How would an overly feminized/sexualized example affect male and female participant performance?
- What about with other politicians used as stimuli? What about our current political climate?

# NEXT CLASSES…

- **Discussion Posts Due Monday 2pm**
- **Language & Belonging Tuesday**
- **Recorded Interactive Lecture Thursday, NO CLASS**

